

BUSINESS CASE

Project Title	Student Income and Part-Time Employment Platform (StudentSarathi)
Project Manager	Ravi Raj
Date	14/03/2026

Project summary

StudentSarathi is a student-focused digital employment platform designed to connect students with verified part-time job opportunities aligned with their academic schedules, skills, and location preferences.

The project addresses the increasing financial challenges faced by students by creating a trusted platform where students can find flexible employment opportunities and employers can access verified student talent.

The project will deliver an MVP-level solution focusing on core features including student registration, employer verification, job posting, job search, and application tracking.

The project will follow structured project management practices covering initiation, planning, execution, monitoring, control, and closure.

Project Constraints

The StudentSarathi project will be delivered under the following constraints:

Constraint Area	Description
• Time Constraint	• The MVP version must be planned and ready for initial launch preparation within the defined project timeline (June 2026 target).
• Resource Constraint	• The project will be managed by a small team with limited resources, requiring effective task prioritization and resource allocation.
• Budget Constraint	• The project has a limited budget of approximately €35,000 for MVP development, infrastructure, verification processes, documentation, and initial marketing activities.
• Technical Constraint	• The platform must support Android users and function effectively with basic internet connectivity.
• Scope Constraint	• The first version will focus only on core MVP features such as student registration, employer registration, job posting, job search, application tracking, and communication.
• Regulatory Constraint	• The platform must comply with applicable Indian labour laws, data protection requirements, and digital privacy regulations.

• Operational Constraint	• The project is limited to a conceptual MVP simulation environment and does not include full production deployment.
• Technology Constraint	• The project will depend on available tools and platforms for design, documentation, tracking, and simulation activities.

Problem Statement

Many students face financial pressure due to increasing education and living costs. Existing employment platforms are often designed for full-time professionals and do not fully support student-specific requirements.

Current challenges include:

- Unverified job postings
- Lack of flexible working options
- Difficulty balancing work and studies
- Limited trust between students and employers
- Dependence on informal job sources

A dedicated student-focused employment platform can improve accessibility, transparency, and trust.

Business Need

- Students across urban regions are experiencing increasing financial pressure due to higher education expenses, rising living costs, and limited access to flexible income opportunities.
- Current employment platforms are mainly designed for full-time professionals and often do not address the specific requirements of students, such as flexible working hours, verified opportunities, and compatibility with academic schedules.
- The lack of a dedicated student employment ecosystem creates several challenges:
- Students struggle to find reliable part-time employment opportunities
- Many available job postings lack verification and transparency
- Students face difficulty balancing work commitments with education
- Employers have limited access to a structured pool of student talent
- Informal employment channels increase the risk of unsuitable or unreliable opportunities
- StudentSarathi addresses this business need by providing a structured digital platform that connects students with verified employers and flexible job opportunities.
- The platform will create value by:
- Improving access to safe and reliable employment options
- Increasing transparency between students and employers

- Supporting flexible work arrangements
- Reducing dependency on informal job sources
- Creating a scalable foundation for future student employment services
- The business need is to establish a trusted, student-focused employment platform that improves financial independence for students while helping employers efficiently connect with suitable candidates.

Project Objectives

- The project aims to:
- Design an MVP-level digital employment platform
 - Create a verified student and employer registration process
 - Enable job posting and application management
 - Provide location-based job discovery
 - Improve transparency in student employment opportunities
 - Demonstrate complete project lifecycle management

Expected Benefits

Student Benefits

- Access to verified part-time jobs
- Flexible opportunities compatible with academic schedules
- Reduced risk of fraudulent job offers
- Improved earning opportunities

Employer Benefits

- Access to student talent pool
- Simplified hiring process
- Better candidate matching

Organizational Benefits

- Improved digital employment ecosystem
- Increased stakeholder engagement
- Scalable platform foundation

Project Scope Summary

In Scope

- Student registration and authentication
- Employer registration and verification
- Job posting management
- Job search and filtering
- Location-based opportunities
- Student profile management
- Application tracking

Out of Scope

- Payroll processing
- Payment gateway integration
- AI-based job recommendations
- International expansion
- Full HR management system
- Production-scale deployment

Project documentation and management activities	
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Estimated Costs

Estimated Project Costs

The following cost estimate represents a conceptual MVP-level project budget for planning and simulation purposes. Actual costs may vary depending on development approach, resources, technology choices, and operational requirements.

Cost Category	Description	Estimated Cost
Project Management	Planning, documentation, coordination, reporting	€3,000
Business Analysis	Requirements gathering, stakeholder analysis, process design	€2,500
UI/UX Design	Platform wireframes, user flows, interface design	€4,000
Software Development	MVP platform development and testing	€15,000
Quality Assurance	Testing, review, defect management	€3,000
Hosting and Infrastructure	Initial hosting, database, basic services	€1,500
Security and Verification	User verification workflow and security setup	€2,000
Training and Documentation	User guides and project documentation	€1,000
Contingency Reserve	Risk response and unexpected costs	€3,200
Total Estimated Budget		
Estimated Total Project Cost: €35,200		

Cost Assumptions

- The estimate is based on MVP-level development
- Development may use existing cloud and software services
- No physical office or hardware costs included
- Costs exclude large-scale marketing campaigns
- Future enhancements will require additional funding

Expected Return / Value

The project is expected to create value through:

- Improved access to verified student employment
- Reduced time spent searching for opportunities
- Increased employer access to student talent
- Creation of a scalable digital employment ecosystem
- Improved trust and transparency in student hiring

Financial Recommendation

Based on the expected benefits and strategic value, the StudentSarthi project is recommended for MVP development and validation before larger-scale investment.

Key Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Interest
Project Sponsor	Business Owner	Project success
Project Manager	Ravi Raj	Planning and delivery
Students	End Users	Find flexible jobs
Employers	Platform Users	Hire student talent
Development Team	Delivery	Build MVP
University Partners	Support	Student adoption

High-Level Risks

Risk	Impact	Response
Low user adoption	High	Focus on simple user experience
Scope expansion	High	Apply change control process
Requirement changes	Medium	Maintain requirement documentation
Timeline delays	Medium	Weekly monitoring and reporting
Limited stakeholder feedback	Medium	Create structured review meetings

Project Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful when:

- MVP design is completed within planned timeline
- Required project documents are delivered
- Stakeholder expectations are addressed
- Risks are identified and managed
- Project objectives are achieved
- Closure documentation is completed

Project Assumptions

- Students have access to smartphones and internet connectivity
- Employers are willing to participate in the platform
- MVP functionality is sufficient for initial validation
- Stakeholders provide timely feedback
- Required project resources remain available
- Project documentation represents realistic project conditions

Project Dependencies

- Availability of project resources
- Availability of technology tools
- Stakeholder participation and feedback
- Access to user requirements

Availability of hosting and platform services

Recommendation / Justification

Based on the identified business problem, expected benefits, and feasibility analysis, developing the StudentSarthi platform is recommended.
The project provides value by creating a structured, secure, and student-friendly employment ecosystem while demonstrating professional project management practices.

Major Deliverables

- Business Case
- Project Charter
- Requirements Document
- Scope Statement
- WBS
- Project Schedule
- Stakeholder Register
- Risk Register
- Communication Plan
- Final Project Report
- Lessons Learned

Approvals

Role	Name	Date	Signature
Project sponsor			
Project Manager			